Indian Legal FAQs & Simple Explanations

150+ Questions on Laws, Rights, and Procedures

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Criminal Law FAQs

1. What is FIR in simple terms?

Answer: FIR (First Information Report) is a written document that police make when you report a crime. It's like registering that a crime has happened. Once filed, police must investigate it.

Example: You report a theft to police → Police write FIR → Police start investigation

2. What is the difference between bail and bond?

Answer:

- **Bail:** Money you give to get released from jail (you get it back if you go to court)
- **Bond:** Money or promise to court that you'll appear for trial

Example: Arrested for hitting someone → Court says "Give ₹10,000 bail" → You pay → You go home → You go to court

3. What does 'remand' mean?

Answer: Remand means police keeping you in custody to investigate further. They need permission from court for this.

Example: Police arrest you → Go to court → Court agrees to "14 days police remand" → Police keep you for questioning

4. What is the difference between murder and manslaughter?

Answer:

- **Murder:** Intentional killing with planning
- **Manslaughter:** Unintentional killing due to negligence or loss of control

Example:

- Murder: A planned attack that kills someone
- Manslaughter: Rash driving that accidentally kills a pedestrian

5. What does 'acquittal' mean?

Answer: Acquittal means the court found you NOT GUILTY of the crime. You're free and innocent legally.

Example: Court says "Not enough evidence to prove guilt" → You're acquitted → Case ends

6. What is 'contempt of court'?

Answer: Disrespecting the court or disobeying court orders. Can result in jail.

Example: Ignoring a court order to appear in court → You can be jailed for contempt

7. What does 'Section 498A' mean? (Cruelty against wife)

Answer: A law to protect married women from cruelty (physical/mental). Husband or in-laws can be punished.

Example: Husband beats wife repeatedly → Wife files 498A case → Husband can go to jail

8. What is 'anticipatory bail'?

Answer: Bail given BEFORE arrest. You ask court for protection if someone threatens to falsely arrest you.

Example: Your business rival threatens to file fake FIR → You file anticipatory bail → Court grants it → If arrested, you're freed immediately

9. What does 'conviction' mean?

Answer: When court finds you GUILTY of a crime. You'll be punished according to law.

Example: Court proves you stole a phone → You're convicted → You get jail time

10. What is 'parole'?

Answer: Temporary release from jail before sentence ends. You must follow conditions and report to police regularly.

Example: Serving 5-year sentence → After 2 years, released on parole → Report to police every week → If you behave, sentence gets reduced

11. What does 'probation' mean?

Answer: Court lets you go free instead of jail, but you must follow rules (like regular check-ins, not committing crime).

Example: First-time shoplifter → Judge says "1 year probation instead of jail" → Must not commit crime for 1 year

12. What is 'witness examination'?

Answer: In court, witnesses answer questions from lawyers to tell their side of the story.

Example: Car accident case → Eye-witness tells court what happened → Lawyer of both sides question them

13. What does 'confession' mean in legal terms?

Answer: You admitting in court that you did the crime. This is strong evidence against you.

Example: In court, you admit "Yes, I stole the money" → This confession counts as evidence

14. What is 'circumstantial evidence'?

Answer: Indirect evidence that suggests guilt but doesn't directly prove it.

Example: Found at crime scene with stolen items → No witness saw you steal → This is circumstantial evidence

15. What does 'alibi' mean?

Answer: Proof that you were somewhere else when crime happened, so you couldn't have done it.

Example: Accused of robbery at 9 PM → You prove you were in hospital at 9 PM → This is your alibi

16. What is 'cross-examination'?

Answer: Opposite lawyer questioning a witness to find inconsistencies or false statements.

Example: Witness says "I saw him steal" → Other lawyer asks "Are you 100% sure? How far were you? Was it dark?" → Witness admits uncertainty

17. What does 'plea bargain' mean?

Answer: You admit guilt to get a lighter sentence. Faster process than full trial.

Example: Charged with theft → Prosecutor says "Admit guilt, get 6 months jail" → You agree → No trial needed

18. What is 'criminal intimidation'?

Answer: When someone threatens, scares, or intimidates you to do something. It's a crime.

Example: Boss says "Steal from company or I'll kill you" → This is criminal intimidation

19. What does 'defamation' mean?

Answer: Making false statements that damage someone's reputation.

Example: Saying someone is a thief when they're not → This damages their reputation → They can sue you

20. What is 'assault' vs 'battery'?

Answer:

- **Assault:** Threat of violence (even if you don't touch)
- **Battery:** Actually hitting or touching someone without permission

Example:

- Assault: "I'll beat you up!" (threat)
- Battery: Actually hitting someone

21. What does 'grievous injury' mean?

Answer: Serious physical injury that causes permanent damage or long-term harm.

Example: Breaking someone's arm that never heals properly → This is grievous injury

22. What is 'simple injury'?

Answer: Minor physical injury that heals without permanent damage.

Example: Light punch that causes bruise for few days → This is simple injury

23. What does 'theft' mean legally?

Answer: Taking someone's property without permission with intention to keep it.

Example: Stealing phone from store → You took it without permission with intent to keep

24. What is 'robbery'?

Answer: Theft done with force, threat, or violence.

Example: Snatching phone with knife threat → This is robbery (theft + violence)

25. What does 'criminal breach of trust' mean?

Answer: When someone trusted with property or money misuses it.

Example: Accountant steals company money → This is breach of trust

26. What is 'cheating' under criminal law?

Answer: Deceiving someone to get money or property.

Example: Selling fake gold as real → This is cheating

27. What does 'dowry' mean and why is it illegal?

Answer: Dowry is property/money given to bride/groom at marriage. Illegal because it led to bride killings and violence.

Example: Groom asking bride's family for ₹5 Lakhs as dowry → This is illegal and both can go to jail

28. What is 'honor killing'?

Answer: Murdering a family member for love marriage or relationship. It's murder under law.

Example: Killing daughter for marrying outside caste → This is honor killing = murder charge

29. What does 'compounding' a crime mean?

Answer: Victim and accused agreeing to end the case without court punishment.

Example: You hit someone → They file case → Later both agree to settle → Case can be "compounded"

30. What is 'statute of limitations'?

Answer: Time limit for filing a case. After this period, you cannot be prosecuted.

Example: Small crime in 2015 → If not reported by 2025, time limit may expire → Cannot charge you

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Civil Law FAQs

31. What is 'contract' in simple terms?

Answer: An agreement between two or more people that is legally binding. Both must do what they agreed.

Example: You agree to buy phone for ₹10,000 → Seller agrees to give phone → Both must follow agreement

32. What does 'breach of contract' mean?

Answer: One person fails to do what they promised in the contract.

Example: Seller takes your ₹10,000 but doesn't give phone → This is breach of contract

33. What is 'damages' in civil law?

Answer: Money paid to compensate for losses caused by breach or wrongful act.

Example: Car accident due to other's negligence → You get medical bills + lost income as damages

34. What does 'tort' mean?

Answer: A wrongful act (not criminal) that harms someone and requires compensation.

Example: Negligent doctor injuring patient → Patient can claim damages (tort, not criminal)

35. What is 'negligence' legally?

Answer: Failing to take reasonable care that results in harm to someone.

Example: Doctor operates drunk → Patient gets permanently injured → Negligence claim

36. What does 'liability' mean?

Answer: Legal responsibility for harm or damage caused.

Example: You hit car in parking → You're liable to pay for damage repairs

37. What is 'indemnity'?

Answer: One person agrees to pay for losses if the other person is harmed.

Example: You hire builder → Builder says "I'm responsible if my workers get injured" → That's indemnity

38. What does 'guarantee' mean in contracts?

Answer: A promise that something will work as promised. If it doesn't, the guarantor pays.

Example: Phone seller gives 1-year guarantee → If phone stops working → Seller must fix/replace

39. What is 'misrepresentation'?

Answer: Giving false information to persuade someone into a contract.

Example: Selling "new" phone when it's refurbished → This is misrepresentation

40. What does 'consideration' mean?

Answer: Something of value exchanged between both parties in a contract.

Example: You give ₹10,000 (consideration) → Seller gives phone (consideration) → Both exchange something valuable

41. What is 'capacity to contract'?

Answer: Legal ability to enter contract. Children, mentally ill persons don't have capacity.

Example: 5-year-old cannot sign binding contract → They lack legal capacity

42. What does 'void contract' mean?

Answer: Agreement that's not legally binding from the start. Cannot be enforced.

Example: Contract for illegal activity (contract to murder) → This is void from day one

43. What is 'voidable contract'?

Answer: Contract that's valid but can be cancelled by one person if they want.

Example: Contract signed due to fraud → Victim can void it if they discover fraud

44. What does 'injunction' mean?

Answer: Court order telling someone to DO something or NOT DO something.

Example: Court order: "Stop selling my name for products" → If you continue, court can jail you

45. What is 'specific performance'?

Answer: Court order making someone do exactly what they promised in contract.

Example: You promised to sell house → Now refusing → Court orders you to complete sale

46. What does 'lien' mean?

Answer: Right to hold someone's property until they pay debt.

Example: Mechanic fixes car → You don't pay → Mechanic can hold your car (lien) until payment

47. What is 'mortgage'?

Answer: Giving property as security for a loan. Bank gets property if you don't repay.

Example: Bank gives ₹20 Lakh home loan → You give house as mortgage → If you don't pay, bank takes house

48. What does 'easement' mean in property?

Answer: Right to use someone else's property for specific purpose.

Example: You have right to walk across neighbor's land to reach your house → This is easement

49. What is 'nuisance' in civil law?

Answer: Using your property in way that harms neighbor's enjoyment of theirs.

Example: Running noisy factory that disturbs neighbor → This is nuisance → Must pay damages

50. What does 'arbitration' mean?

Answer: Private dispute resolution by neutral third person instead of going to court.

Example: Business dispute → Both hire arbitrator → Arbitrator decides → No court needed → Faster & cheaper

51. What is 'mediation'?

Answer: Neutral person helping two parties find their own solution to dispute.

Example: Divorce dispute → Mediator helps couple agree on alimony/custody → They settle themselves

52. What does 'prescription' mean in civil law?

Answer: Right to claim something if you've possessed it openly for many years.

Example: Using someone's land openly for 20 years → You gain right to that land

53. What is 'estoppel'?

Answer: Cannot take back a promise if other person relied on it and would be harmed.

Example: Landlord says "You can stay rent-free" → Tenant moves in → Landlord cannot suddenly demand rent

54. What does 'unjust enrichment' mean?

Answer: Getting benefit without giving anything in return, which is unfair.

Example: You pay ₹1000 for service, but service provider keeps money and disappears → Unjust enrichment → Can claim refund

55. What is 'limitation period' in civil law?

Answer: Time limit to file a civil case. After this, cannot sue.

Example: Contract breach in 2015 → Usually 3 years to sue → If filed in 2018, might be barred

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Family Law FAQs

56. What is 'marriage' legally?

Answer: Legal union between two people creating rights and duties towards each other and children.

Example: Two adults get married → They become each other's legal heirs, can claim maintenance, own property together

57. What is 'divorce'?

Answer: Legal dissolution of marriage. Both are free from each other after divorce.

Example: Marriage ends legally → Can remarry, property is divided → Ex-spouse no longer heir

58. What does 'mutual consent divorce' mean?

Answer: Both husband and wife agree to divorce. Faster, no court hearing, just paperwork.

Example: Couple agrees to separate → File divorce together → Court approves → Divorce final in few weeks

59. What is 'contested divorce'?

Answer: One person doesn't agree to divorce. Long court case needed.

Example: Husband wants divorce, wife refuses → Court case for 2-3 years → Court decides custody, maintenance, property division

60. What does 'cruelty' mean in marriage?

Answer: Physical or mental harm by spouse. Valid ground for divorce.

Example: Husband beats wife regularly → Wife can file divorce on grounds of cruelty

61. What is 'adultery'?

Answer: Having relationship outside marriage. Earlier crime, now civil grounds for divorce only.

Example: Husband has affair → Wife can file divorce → No jail for adultery anymore

62. What does 'desertion' mean?

Answer: Spouse leaving you without intention to return. Valid divorce ground.

Example: Husband leaves for 2 years without contact/permission → Wife can divorce on desertion

63. What is 'maintenance' in family law?

Answer: Money paid by one spouse to other after separation/divorce for living expenses.

Example: Husband earns ₹1 Lakh/month, wife earns nothing → Wife gets ₹30,000/month maintenance

64. What does 'alimony' mean?

Answer: Maintenance paid by earning spouse to non-earning spouse after divorce.

Example: Husband works, wife was housewife → After divorce, husband pays alimony

65. What is 'custody' of children?

Answer: Legal right to take decisions about child's upbringing, education, health.

Example: After divorce, mother gets custody → Mother decides where child studies, religious upbringing, medical decisions

66. What does 'guardianship' mean?

Answer: Legal responsibility for child when parents cannot care (dead, disabled, unfit).

Example: Parents die in accident → Court appoints grandparent as guardian → Grandparent makes decisions for child

67. What is 'legitimacy' of children?

Answer: Legal status of child born in marriage. Legitimate child has full rights.

Example: Child born after marriage → Legitimate → Inherits parents' property, gets surname, full rights

68. What is 'illegitimate child'?

Answer: Child born outside marriage. Has some limited rights to father's property.

Example: Unmarried couple's child → Illegitimate → Can claim maintenance from father, but not full inheritance

69. What does 'adoption' mean?

Answer: Legal process of taking someone else's child as your own child.

Example: Couple adopts orphan → Adopted child gets full rights as biological child → Inherits property, gets surname

70. What is 'succession' in family law?

Answer: Legal process of inheriting property after someone dies.

Example: Father dies → Property distributed to widow, children per inheritance laws → This is succession

71. What does 'will' mean?

Answer: Written document saying who gets your property after death.

Example: You write will: "House to son, jewelry to daughter" → After death, property divided as per will

72. What is 'intestate succession'?

Answer: When someone dies without will. Property divided by law, not their choice.

Example: Person dies without will → Son, daughter, widow get fixed shares per law → No choice in division

73. What does 'dower' mean in Islamic law?

Answer: Property given by groom to bride at marriage as her security.

Example: Groom gives ₹2 Lakh dower → This belongs to bride → Even if divorced, she keeps dower

74. What is 'bigamy'?

Answer: Marrying second person while first marriage is still valid. It's a crime.

Example: Husband marries second wife while still married to first → This is bigamy, goes to jail

75. What does 'restitution of conjugal rights' mean?

Answer: Court order to spouses to live together. Rarely given now.

Example: Husband leaves → Wife asks court to order him to return → Court generally refuses (personal freedom valued)

Labour Law FAQs

76. What is 'minimum wage'?

Answer: Lowest money employer must pay workers per law.

Example: Government says minimum wage is ₹200/day → Employer must pay at least ₹200/day, no less

77. What does 'working hours' mean?

Answer: Time you must work per day. Usually 8 hours, rest is rest.

Example: 9 AM to 6 PM = 8 working hours → If you work extra, it's overtime

78. What is 'overtime'?

Answer: Working more than 8 hours per day. Paid at higher rate.

Example: Worked 10 hours (2 hours extra) → Get paid 8 hours + 2 hours at 1.5x rate

79. What does 'dismissal' mean?

Answer: Employer firing you from job. Must have valid reason.

Example: Employee steals from company → Employer dismisses them with notice

80. What is 'wrongful dismissal'?

Answer: Firing without valid reason or proper procedure. Employee can claim compensation.

Example: Boss fires you suddenly because you refused to bribe them → Wrongful dismissal → Can claim damages

81. What does 'retrenchment' mean?

Answer: Employer reducing workforce due to business reasons (not employee's fault).

Example: Company loses profits → Retrenches 100 workers → Must give severance pay + notice

82. What is 'gratuity'?

Answer: Lump sum money given to employee when retiring or leaving after long service.

Example: Worked 20 years → Retire → Get gratuity = 15 days salary × years of service

83. What does 'provident fund' mean?

Answer: Money deducted from salary and kept for you. You get it on retirement or leaving job.

Example: ₹5000/month deducted → After 30 years, you have ₹18 Lakh provident fund

84. What is 'unfair labor practice'?

Answer: Employer doing things against worker rights (no union, firing for complaint, cutting wages illegally).

Example: Employer fires worker for joining union → This is unfair labor practice

85. What does 'lockout' mean?

Answer: Employer closing factory to force workers to accept terms.

Example: Workers demand wage raise → Employer locks factory → Workers have no work → Factory reopens when workers accept

86. What is 'strike'?

Answer: Workers stopping work to force employer into negotiations.

Example: Workers demand bonus → Employer refuses → Workers go on strike → No work → Employer negotiates

87. What does 'union' or 'trade union' mean?

Answer: Organization of workers to protect their rights and negotiate with employer.

Example: Factory workers form union → Union negotiates wages, conditions → Gives workers collective power

88. What is 'workmen's compensation'?

Answer: Money paid to worker injured or killed in job.

Example: Worker hurt in factory accident → Gets compensation for medical bills + lost wages + permanent disability

89. What does 'accident' mean in labor law?

Answer: Unexpected injury during work. Employer is liable.

Example: Machine malfunctions and injures worker → Worker gets compensation

90. What is 'maternity benefit'?

Answer: Paid leave and money for pregnant working women before and after delivery.

Example: Pregnant woman gets 3 months paid leave before delivery + 3 months after → Gets full salary

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Property Law FAQs

91. What is 'property' in legal terms?

Answer: Anything of value that you can own - house, land, car, money, etc.

Example: Your home, jewelry, bank account, all are your property

92. What is 'real property' vs 'personal property'?

Answer:

- **Real:** Land and buildings (fixed, cannot move)
- **Personal:** Moveable things like car, phone, money

Example:

- Real: House, land
- Personal: Phone, clothes, furniture

93. What does 'title' mean in property?

Answer: Legal proof that you own property.

Example: House deed showing your name = you have title to house

94. What is 'mortgage'?

Answer: Giving property as security for loan. If you don't repay, lender gets property.

Example: Bank gives ₹20 Lakh loan → You mortgage house → If you don't repay, bank sells house

95. What does 'encumbrance' mean?

Answer: Someone else's right over your property (mortgage, tax, easement).

Example: Mortgaged house has bank's right → Bank is encumbrance on your property

96. What is 'conveyance' of property?

Answer: Legal transfer of property from one person to another.

Example: You sell house to neighbor → This transfer is conveyance

97. What does 'deed' mean?

Answer: Legal document proving ownership transfer of property.

Example: House deed shows seller transferred property to buyer → Deed is proof of ownership

98. What is 'registration' of property?

Answer: Recording property sale in government registry as official record.

Example: You buy house → Register deed in property registry → Now officially on record that you own house

99. What does 'possession' mean?

Answer: Having control and use of property, even if you don't own it.

Example: Renting an apartment → You have possession (can live in it) but owner owns it

100. What is 'adverse possession'?

Answer: Gaining ownership by using land openly for many years (15-30 years).

Example: Using someone's abandoned land for 20 years openly → After that, you can claim ownership

101. What does 'easement' mean?

Answer: Right to use someone else's property for specific purpose.

Example: Right to walk across neighbor's land to reach your house = easement

102. What is 'usufruct'?

Answer: Right to use and enjoy someone else's property but not own it.

Example: Life tenant can live in house, use it, but cannot sell it

103. What does 'eviction' mean?

Answer: Legal removal of person from property they're occupying.

Example: Tenant doesn't pay rent → Landlord files case → Court orders eviction → Tenant must leave

104. What is 'trespass' in property law?

Answer: Entering someone else's property without permission.

Example: Entering someone's house without permission = trespass

105. What does 'nuisance' mean?

Answer: Using property in way that harms neighbor's enjoyment of theirs.

Example: Running loud business that disturbs neighbor = nuisance = must pay damages

106. What is 'boundary dispute'?

Answer: Disagreement between neighbors about where property line is.

Example: You say fence is on your side, neighbor says it's on theirs → Boundary dispute → Court surveys land

107. What does 'partition' mean?

Answer: Dividing joint property among owners.

Example: Parents die leaving house to two sons → Sons partition house: son 1 gets half, son 2 gets half

108. What is 'succession certificate'?

Answer: Certificate proving you're legal heir to deceased's property.

Example: Father dies with bank account → Get succession certificate → Can withdraw money as legal heir

109. What does 'power of attorney' mean?

Answer: Giving someone authority to act for you in property matters.

Example: You give power of attorney to friend → Friend can sell your property on your behalf

110. What is 'gift deed'?

Answer: Legal document transferring property as gift with no money exchanged.

Example: Mother gives house to son through gift deed → Son owns house, no money paid

Consumer Rights FAQs

111. What is 'consumer' legally?

Answer: Person buying products or services for personal use (not business).

Example: You buy phone for personal use = consumer

112. What does 'Consumer Protection Act' mean?

Answer: Law protecting consumers from defective products and unfair business practices.

Example: Company selling defective phone → Consumer Act protects you → Can claim refund + damages

113. What is 'warranty'?

Answer: Seller's promise that product will work for specific time.

Example: Phone warranty = if phone breaks within 1 year (not due to damage), seller fixes/replaces free

114. What does 'guarantee' mean?

Answer: Similar to warranty but stronger - seller fully responsible for quality.

Example: Car guarantee = if engine fails within 1 year, dealer replaces for free

115. What is 'defective product'?

Answer: Product that doesn't work as promised or has problems.

Example: Refrigerator stops cooling after 2 months = defective = can return for refund/replacement

116. What does 'adulteration' mean?

Answer: Mixing harmful/cheap substances into food/medicine to make profit.

Example: Mixing expired oil into pure oil = adulteration = criminal offense

117. What is 'misleading advertisement'?

Answer: False claims in ads to attract buyers.

Example: Cream claiming "Makes you fair in 15 days" when it doesn't = misleading ad = fine + penalty

118. What does 'refund' mean?

Answer: Returning money if product is defective or not as promised.

Example: Buy ₹1000 shirt, tears after 1 week = defective = can get ₹1000 refund

119. What is 'replacement' of product?

Answer: Getting new product of same type in place of defective one.

Example: Phone is defective = can get brand new replacement instead of repair

120. What does 'complaint' mean in consumer law?

Answer: Filing formal complaint with consumer forum about defective product/service.

Example: Buy defective phone → File complaint in consumer forum → Forum orders seller to refund

121. What is 'compensation' in consumer cases?

Answer: Money paid by seller for defect or unfair business practice.

Example: Defective medicine causes injury → Seller pays compensation for medical bills + suffering

122. What does 'recall' mean?

Answer: Manufacturer calling back defective products from market due to safety issues.

Example: Car model has brake problem → Manufacturer recalls all cars → Owners get free repair

123. What is 'expiry date' of products?

Answer: Date after which product is not safe or effective to use.

Example: Milk expiry 15-May → After that, not safe to drink → Cannot sell after expiry

124. What does 'return policy' mean?

Answer: Rules about how long you can return product and get refund/replacement.

Example: Shop return policy: "30 days money-back guarantee" = can return within 30 days for refund

125. What is 'service complaint'?

Answer: Complaint about poor quality service (not product).

Example: Poor haircut at salon = service complaint = can claim compensation

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Constitutional Rights FAQs

126. What is 'Constitution'?

Answer: Document that lists government's powers and citizens' rights.

Example: Constitution says you have right to free speech, freedom to move, right to education

127. What does 'fundamental right' mean?

Answer: Basic rights given to all citizens that government cannot take away.

Example: Right to free speech, right to life, right to equality are fundamental rights

128. What is 'right to equality'?

Answer: No discrimination based on caste, color, religion, sex, or place of birth.

Example: Job cannot be denied just because you're from certain religion = right to equality

129. What does 'freedom of speech' mean?

Answer: Right to say anything without government stopping you (with few exceptions).

Example: Can criticize government, write articles, protest peacefully = freedom of speech

130. What is 'freedom of assembly'?

Answer: Right to gather and protest peacefully in group.

Example: 1000 people can gather to protest unfair law = freedom of assembly

131. What does 'freedom of religion' mean?

Answer: Right to follow any religion or no religion.

Example: Can practice Hindu, Muslim, Christian, or no religion = freedom of religion

132. What is 'right to property'?

Answer: Right to own, buy, sell property (limited now, not fundamental).

Example: Can buy house, car, land = right to property

133. What does 'right to vote' mean?

Answer: Right to vote in elections if citizen and above 18 years.

Example: Every citizen aged 18+ can vote in elections = right to vote

134. What is 'right to education'?

Answer: Right to free and compulsory education for children aged 6-14.

Example: Government must provide free schooling to all children = right to education

135. What does 'right to information' mean?

Answer: Right to get government information under RTI Act.

Example: Can ask government for budget details = right to information

136. What is 'right to movement'?

Answer: Right to move freely within India and live anywhere.

Example: Can leave city, move to another state = right to movement

137. What does 'right to justice' mean?

Answer: Right to fair trial and court proceedings if wronged.

Example: If someone harms you, can file case in court = right to justice

138. What is 'right against exploitation'?

Answer: Protection against forced labor, child labor, human trafficking.

Example: Cannot be forced to work, children cannot be made to work = right against exploitation

139. What does 'habeas corpus' mean?

Answer: Legal protection against wrongful imprisonment.

Example: If wrongly arrested, can petition court "Habeas Corpus" → Court must release you if no valid reason

140. What is 'public interest litigation'?

Answer: Anyone can file court case for public welfare (not personal dispute).

Example: Environmental activist can file case to protect forests = public interest litigation

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Business/Corporate FAQs

141. What is 'partnership'?

Answer: Business owned by 2+ people who share profit and liability.

Example: Three friends start restaurant together as partners = they own together, profit is shared

142. What does 'sole proprietorship' mean?

Answer: Business owned and run by single person.

Example: You start small shop alone = sole proprietorship = you own everything, liable for all debts

143. What is 'limited liability company' (LLC)?

Answer: Business structure where owners' personal liability is limited to their investment.

Example: Start company with ₹10 Lakh investment → If company fails, you lose only ₹10 Lakh, not personal property

144. What does 'corporation' mean?

Answer: Large business structure that is legally separate from owners (shareholders).

Example: TCS is corporation = legally separate from all shareholders = shareholders not personally liable for company debts

145. What is 'tax' in business?

Answer: Money business must pay to government based on profits.

Example: Made ₹1 Lakh profit → Pay ₹20,000 tax to government

146. What does 'audit' mean?

Answer: Checking company's financial records for accuracy and honesty.

Example: Company accounts audited by CA → CA checks if money properly recorded and no fraud

147. What is 'franchise'?

Answer: Right to use company's brand/system to run business (pay royalty).

Example: Open McDonald's franchise = use their brand, system → Pay them % of profit

148. What does 'intellectual property' mean?

Answer: Ownership of ideas, inventions, names, designs (patents, trademarks, copyrights).

Example: Your company logo = intellectual property = cannot be copied by others

149. What is 'copyright'?

Answer: Legal right over original creative work (books, songs, movies, art).

Example: Wrote a book = copyright protection = others cannot copy without permission

150. What is 'bankruptcy'?

Answer: Legal process when person/company cannot pay debts.

Example: Company owes ₹1 Crore but has only ₹20 Lakh → Files bankruptcy → Assets sold to pay creditors

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Quick Reference: Common Legal Terms

Term	Simple Meaning	Example
FIR	Police report of crime	Report theft to police
Bail	Money to get released from jail	Pay ₹10,000 → Go home
Remand	Police keeping you in custody	Arrested, police want to question
Acquittal	Found NOT guilty	Court: No evidence → Free
Conviction	Found GUILTY	Court: Guilty → Go to jail
Divorce	Marriage ends	Couple separates legally
Custody	Child's living arrangements	Mother gets child after divorce
Maintenance	Money after divorce	Ex-pays for living expenses

Contract	Legal agreement	Promise to buy/sell something
Breach	Breaking a contract	Don't do what you promised
Damages	Money compensation	Paid for losses caused
Property	Things you own	House, car, money
Warranty	Seller's guarantee	Product works for 1 year
Complaint	Formal objection	Defective product complaint
Rights	Legal protections	Freedom of speech, right to vote

Key Principles for Citizens

1. Rule of Law

Everyone is equal before law. No one is above law. Same rules apply to all.

2. Justice Delayed is Justice Denied

Court cases should be fast. Long delays mean justice is lost.

3. Burden of Proof

In criminal cases, prosecution must prove guilt (not you proving innocence).

4. Innocent Until Proven Guilty

You're presumed innocent until court proves you guilty.

5. Right to Lawyer

Can hire lawyer to defend you in court.

6. Fair Trial

Right to present your side in court and cross-examine witnesses.

7. Appeal Rights

If unhappy with court's decision, can appeal to higher court.

8. Compensation for Wrongful Prosecution

If wrongly arrested/prosecuted, can claim compensation.

Where to Get Help

- **Legal Aid Society:** Free lawyers for poor people
- **Consumer Forum:** Complaint about defective products
- **Labor Department:** Complaint against employer
- **Police Station:** Report crimes
- **District Court:** File civil cases
- **High Court:** Appeal against lower court decisions
- **Supreme Court:** Final appeal for important cases

Note: This FAQ is for general knowledge. Always consult qualified lawyer for specific legal advice. Laws keep changing - verify information with official sources.

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